

Illustrative ROI – the working in full

Every assumption shown. Designed to survive scrutiny rather than dazzle with a single fabricated number. Swap your school's figures in and recompute.

Companion to the *Solutions and Value* document.

Most EdTech ROI material quotes a single big number – "saves teachers ten hours a week" – and hopes nobody pulls on the thread. This document does the opposite. Every assumption is visible, so the finance team can swap its own school's figures in and decide for itself.

HOW TO READ THIS DOCUMENT

If the calculation comes out negative after you've swapped your numbers in, **we are not the right tool for your school** and you should not buy us. The point of this document is to help you decide, not to pressure you.

THREE NUMBERS WE WILL NOT QUOTE

What we explicitly do not claim

NO FABRICATED GRADE DELTA

We do not have a validated outcome study yet. Anyone in the EdTech AI space who quotes you a specific grade-delta number should be asked to show you the methodology. Most cannot.

NO AGGREGATE "HOURS SAVED PER WEEK"

Any aggregate number is meaningless because it depends entirely on your department size, current marking practice, and adoption depth. Our calculation is per-cohort and per-month — you can roll it up to your school's actual scale.

NO "X % OF SCHOOLS RENEW"

We have not yet completed a single annual cycle. Anyone in EdTech telling you their renewal rate before they have one year of data is making it up.

LEVER 1 — RECLAIMED TEACHER MARKING TIME

The main monetised value

Inputs (swap your school's numbers in)

INPUT	DEFAULT	YOUR SCHOOL
Students in the cohort writing practice essays	80	-----
Practice essays per student per month	2 (fortnightly)	-----
Teacher marking time per practice essay (current process)	20 minutes	-----
Months in the academic year (excluding exam term)	9	-----
Fully-loaded teacher cost per hour (GCC mid-range)	£30	-----

The maths

Total practice essays per month

- = Students × Essays per student per month
- = 80 × 2
- = 160 essays / month

Total teacher marking time per month

- = Essays × Time per essay
- = 160 × 20 minutes
- = 3,200 minutes
- = 53.3 hours / month

Monthly value of reclaimed time

- = Hours × Hourly rate
- = 53.3 × £30
- = £1,600 / month

Annual value (over 9 academic-year months)

- = £1,600 × 9
- = £14,400 / year

Compared to the annual deployment fee

£6,000+

Annual deployment fee (small school, single campus, from)

£14,400

Annualised value of reclaimed marking time,

~2.4×

Plausible ROI on Lever 1 alone, for one year group at the small-school fee

If your department has more than one practice-essay-writing cohort (and it does — Y10, Y11, Y12, Y13 all write practice essays), the calculation scales. For a department covering Y10–Y13 with broadly similar cohort sizes, the small-school fee is recoverable several times over on Lever 1 alone.

LEVER 2 — EARLIER FEEDBACK TIMING

Compounding revision time (qualitative)

Feedback that lands within minutes of writing lets the student act on it *while the work is mentally fresh*. Feedback that lands 7–14 days later requires the student to re-read their own essay, reconstruct what they were trying to say, then process the comments — and almost no Year 11 student actually does this. The 7–14-day-later feedback is, for most students, lost.

The platform delivers AO-referenced feedback in under a minute. Whether this translates to a measurable grade delta depends on how many essays the student actually writes (Lever 1), how carefully they action the feedback (depends on the student), and how specifically the feedback is tied to the mark scheme (where we invest engineering effort).

WHAT WE ARE NOT GOING TO DO

Multiply a fake "minutes of revision time gained" by a fake "grade points per revision hour" and call it ROI. That arithmetic is bunk and a finance team will see through it. Treat Lever 2 as a free option on top of the Lever 1 ROI.

LEVER 3 — AVOIDED PROCUREMENT-RISK COST

The cost most ROI pitches ignore

If your school procures an EdTech AI tool that turns out not to be PDPPL Article 17 compliant, or trains on student data, or hosts in the wrong jurisdiction, the cost is not just the licence fee

— it is:

- Legal review cost to extract you from the contract (£3,000–£10,000)
- Parent communications cost when the issue becomes public (£2,000–£5,000 of senior staff time)
- DPA renegotiation cost with a replacement vendor (£5,000–£15,000 of legal + procurement time)
- NCGAA scrutiny cost if the regulator notices (open-ended)
- Brand cost to the school's procurement reputation (open-ended)

By having done the homework *before* you ask — Article 17 cross-border consent live in signup, three v1.0 DPIAs, separately-appointed DPO + DSL, EU-region primary database, zero AI-training on student data contractually, Article 16 permit dossier shelf-ready — we eliminate the procurement-risk cost line entirely.

This is worth, conservatively, £10,000+ in avoided downside. Not annually — once, on procurement.

LEVER 4 — PARENT ENGAGEMENT UPLIFT

The comms asset thrown in (qualitative)

Schools that send well-designed weekly parent progress emails have measurably higher renewal rates, fewer complaints, and a stronger word-of-mouth pipeline for admissions. The platform sends consent-gated weekly parent emails by default — modules completed, time on platform, weak areas identified, working-at grade — without any extra effort from the English department.

We do not quote a "parent NPS uplift" or "admissions enquiry uplift" — we have no measured data. Treat Lever 4, like Lever 2, as a free option on top of the Lever 1 ROI.

THE SUMMARY

Value stack at a glance

LEVER	WHAT WE CREDIBLY EVIDENCE	INDICATIVE VALUE
1 — Reclaimed marking time	Per-cohort calculation, full working above	£14,400 / year per year group (default assumptions)
2 — Earlier feedback timing	Qualitative; research-supported; we do not monetise	Free option on top of Lever 1
3 — Avoided procurement-risk cost	One-off saving at procurement	£10,000+ one-off
4 — Parent engagement uplift	Qualitative; comms asset thrown in	Free option on top of Lever 1

The honest range: **several times ROI on the annual fee from Lever 1 alone** for a multi-cohort English department, plus a **one-off £10,000+ on Lever 3 in Year 1**. If your school's marking practice already has 7-day turnaround and the department is fully staffed, the ROI is at the low end. If your school is running 14+ days behind on marking and short-staffed in the English department, it is at the high end.

Walk through this with us

We will do a 30-minute call walking through this calculation with **your school's actual numbers** in front of us. No pitch — just the maths.

Email dpo@theenglishhub.app with subject "ROI walkthrough — [your school name]".